Practice workbook · Improving a study: method and measures

Suggesting a change to how a study is run or measured: standardisation, control groups, design, test materials, independent raters or ethics.

13 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 12 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-RM-22

1. Question 18 · part b · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

18 Matthew has been asked to assess a patient who has had a brain injury.

He decided to give the patient a series of pictures of objects and a photograph of someone from the patient's social media page. The objects included a set of keys, a games console, and a boat's anchor. Matthew asked the patient to name what they could see in the pictures and who they saw in the photograph.

The patient could not name the objects but was able to recognise the person in the photograph.

(a) Explain what the results of Matthew's assessment indicated for the patient.

You should refer to a concept of neurological damage in your answer.

(2)

(b) Explain **one** improvement that could have been made to Matthew's assessment of the patient.

(2)

(Total for Question 18 = 4 marks)

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1. Question 18 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 7 · part c · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

7 Lara wanted to investigate different forms of revision with her Geography classes.

Class 1 and class 2 were given a list of 12 capital cities to learn for a Geography test.

Class 1 were given grouped capital cities with the same first letter.

Class 2 were given ungrouped capital cities.

Figure 2 shows the lists given to class 1 and class 2.



Figure 2

Class 1 scored higher on average for the Geography test.

(a) Explain **one** reason for the higher performance of class 1 compared to class 2.
You should refer to the Multi-store Model of Memory in your answer.

(2)

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2. Question 7 · part c · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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The performance of the students in class 1 is shown in **Figure 3**.

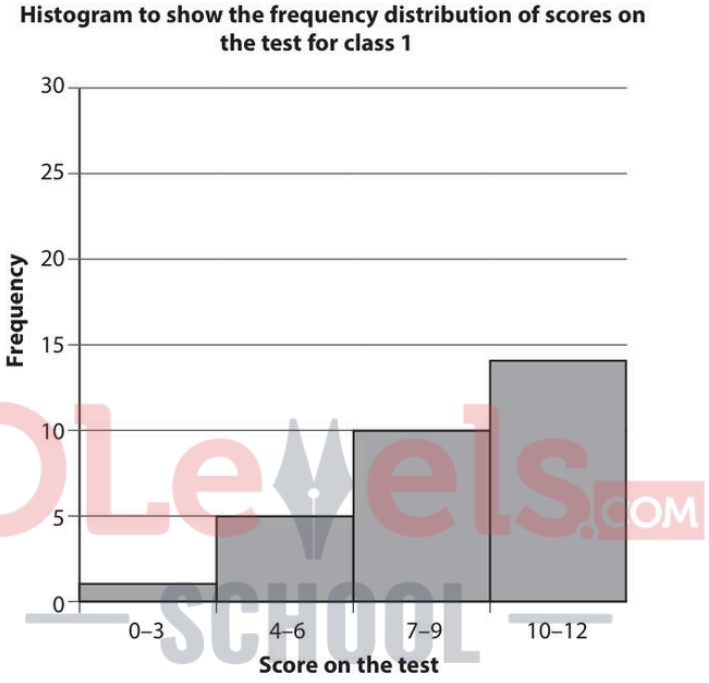


Figure 3

(b) Explain **one** conclusion that can be made regarding the type of distribution shown in **Figure 3**.

(2)

2. Question 7 · part c · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

(c) Explain **one** improvement that Lara could make to her investigation.

(2)

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(Total for Question 7 = 6 marks)

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Working and answer

3. Question 4 · part b · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

4 Two P.E. teachers motivate their pupils differently in their lessons. The assistant head teacher wants to see how this affects the number of times each pupil attempts to break the school records in athletics.

Mr Kirkman praised pupil effort when they were running the 100m and doing the long jump. Mr Moakler praised pupil ability when they were running the 1500m and doing the high jump.

Each pupil was allowed a maximum of 10 attempts to try to break the school record for each event. The assistant head teacher measured the average number of attempts each pupil made to beat the school records.

Figure 1 shows the findings.

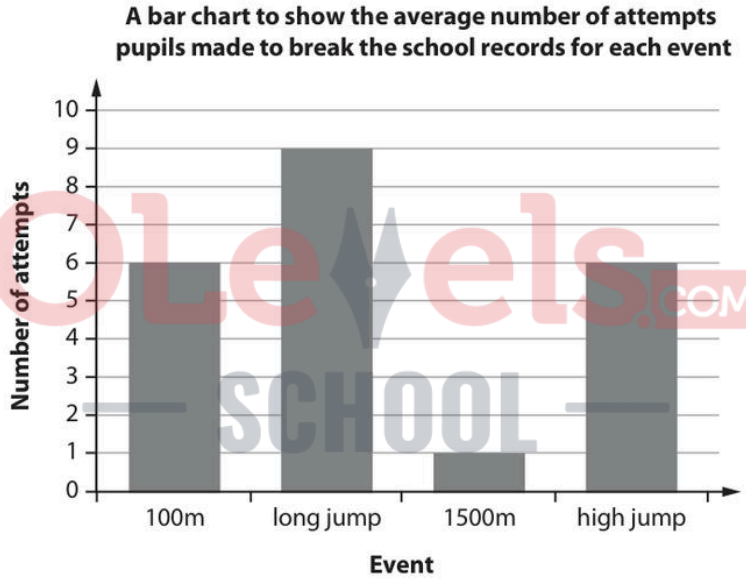


Figure 1

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3. Question 4 · part b · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(a) Explain **one** conclusion you could make using the data in **Figure 1** regarding the type of praise given by each of the P.E. teachers.

(2)

(b) Explain **one** improvement that the assistant head teacher could make to her investigation into the influence of types of praise.

(2)

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(Total for Question 4 = 4 marks)

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3. Question 4 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 11 · part whole · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

11 Niamh wanted to see how music lyrics could most accurately be remembered.

She asked one group of participants to watch the first music video that came on television and a second group of participants to listen to the first song that came on the radio.

Niamh later asked participants to write down all the lyrics they could remember from the song they heard. She then calculated the average percentage of lyrics recalled accurately for each group.

Her results are shown in **Figure 3.**

A bar chart to show the average percentage of lyrics recalled accurately by the participants who watched a music video or listened to the radio

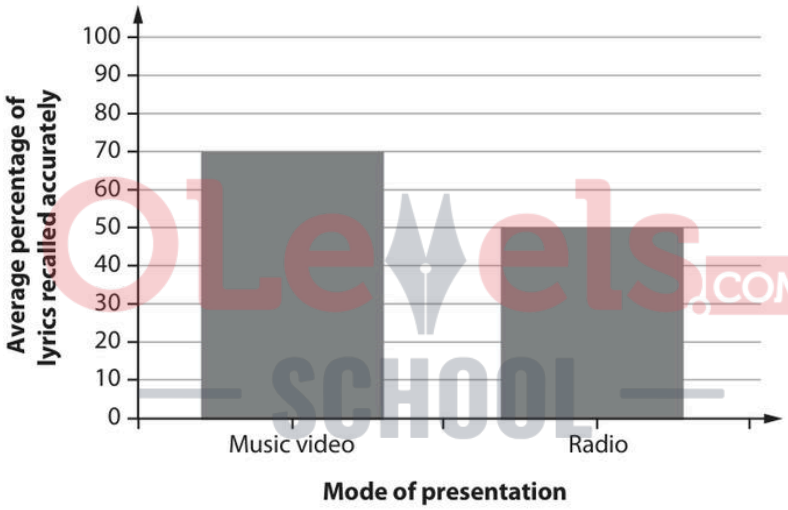


Figure 3

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4. Question 11 · part whole · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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Explain **two** improvements that Niamh could have made to her study.

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(Total for Question 11 = 4 marks)

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4. Question 11 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 5 · part b · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

5 James is a teacher at a school. He wants to see whether social learning can be used to help the social development of his pupils.

He splits a group of 10 pupils in half, keeping five of the pupils in his classroom while another teacher takes the other five pupils to their classroom. James shows them how to share and take turns on a scooter and asks them to practise this whilst he watches and supervises them. The other teacher just gives the pupils a scooter and supervises only. This is done once a day for a week.

The following week James observes his whole class and gives each of the 10 pupils a score for their ability to share and take turns. The pupils were scored from 1 to 10, where 1 indicated very poor ability to share and take turns and 10 indicated excellent ability to share and take turns.

Table 1 shows the scores given to each pupil by James.

Supervised by James		Supervised by the other teacher	
Pupil	**Ability to share and take turns (1–10)**	**Pupil**	**Ability to share and take turns (1–10)**
A	8	F	4
B	9	G	5
C	8	H	5
D	7	I	4
E	9	J	6

Table 1

(a) Explain **one** conclusion you could make from **Table 1** regarding social learning to improve social development.

(2)

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5. Question 5 · part b · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** improvement that James could have made to his investigation.

(2)

(Total for Question 5 = 4 marks)

Working and answer

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6. Question 9 · part b · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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9 Nishka was interested in the amount of numbers that a person could remember over a short period of time.

She presented a group of participants with seven number lists. The number lists were shown one by one to the group. Each number list increased in length with each successive trial, up to a maximum of 10 numbers (see **Figure 3**).

Nishka's number lists

Trial 1:	**8**	**1**	**5**	**0**					
Trial 2:	**4**	**2**	**3**	**9**	**6**				
Trial 3:	**3**	**8**	**1**	**0**	**4**	**5**			
Trial 4:	**2**	**7**	**1**	**5**	**6**	**9**	**1**		
Trial 5:	**5**	**0**	**2**	**1**	**7**	**3**	**8**	**4**	
Trial 6:	**0**	**2**	**9**	**1**	**3**	**0**	**4**	**7**	**5**
Trial 7:	**1**	**6**	**2**	**7**	**8**	**4**	**1**	**3**	**5**	**2**

Figure 3

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At the end of each trial, participants had to write down the numbers in the order that they saw them. Participants only continued to the next trial if they successfully completed the previous trial.

(a) Explain, using your knowledge of the capacity of short-term memory, what Nishka is likely to find.

(2)

6. Question 9 · part b · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(b) Explain **one** improvement Nishka could make to her study.

(2)

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(Total for Question 9 = 4 marks)

Working and answer

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7. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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8 Ivana is a psychologist who has been sent a patient who may have developed retrograde amnesia in the past six months.

To assess whether the patient has retrograde amnesia, Ivana decides to give the patient a test. The test involves giving the patient a set of photographs of 20 famous people who appeared in the news regularly for a five-year period prior to the test.

(a) Explain what Ivana is likely to find if the patient has retrograde amnesia.

You should refer to retrograde amnesia in your answer.

(2)

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7. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(b) Explain **two** improvements that could have been made to the test Ivana gave to the patient with potential retrograde amnesia.

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(Total for Question 8 = 6 marks)

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7. Question 8 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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8. Question 8 · part b · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

8 Lucía is concerned about her partner who has had a fall and hit their head. They have been very confused since the fall and Lucía has arranged for a psychological evaluation to see if her partner has anterograde amnesia.

Lucía's partner is given a test by the psychologist to determine whether they have anterograde amnesia. The psychologist gives Lucía's partner 10 news events that were reported on social media since their fall and asks them to recall everything they can about the events.

(a) Explain what the psychologist is likely to find if Lucía's partner has anterograde amnesia.

You should refer to anterograde amnesia in your answer.

(2)

(b) Explain **one** improvement that could have been made to the test the psychologist gave to Lucía's partner.

(2)

(Total for Question 8 = 4 marks)

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8. Question 8 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

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9. Question 12 · part b · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

12 Researchers have developed a new drug called 8-Gv2, which they think may be able to help treat depression.

They gave the drug to 200 long-term depressed patients over a 12-month period. The researchers measured the self-reported symptom severity of the participants out of 10, where 10 is very severe symptoms and 0 is no symptoms at all.

The results of the follow-ups are shown in **Table 2**.

Follow-up period	Average self-reported symptom severity (out of 10)
Before taking the drug	6.4
3 months	6.4
6 months	6.2
12 months	6.3

Table 2

(a) Explain **one** conclusion that could be made from the data in **Table 2** regarding the use of the drug 8-Gv2 for depression.

(2)

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9. Question 12 · part b · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** improvement that could have been made to the drug treatment study.

(2)

(Total for Question 12 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

10. Question 14 · part b · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

14 Jonah is investigating the influence of different information on whether patients will consider using cognitive behavioural therapy (CBT) for depression.

Jonah gave a group of patients with depression one of two information articles.

- Article one included a case study of a woman with depression who attended CBT sessions and her symptoms reduced over time (group 1).
- Article two included some research evidence supporting the effectiveness of CBT for depression (group 2).

After each group of patients had read their information article, they had to rate how convincing they found the information article for helping with depression and how likely they were to attend CBT.

The articles were rated by the patients on a scale of 1–10, where 1 was extremely unconvinced and unlikely to attend CBT and 10 was extremely convinced and extremely likely to attend CBT.

Table 3 shows a summary of Jonah's results.

Group	Average rating of how convinced they were of CBT helping with their depression (1–10)	Average likelihood of attending CBT after reading the information article (1–10)
Group 1: patients given an information article that included a case study	8.7	7.0
Group 2: patients given an information article that included research evidence	6.5	7.1

Table 3

(a) Explain **one** conclusion that can be made from the data in **Table 3**.

(2)

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10. Question 14 · part b · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** improvement that Jonah could have made to his investigation.

(2)

(Total for Question 14 = 4 marks)

Working and answer

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11. Question 13 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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13 Young (2007) carried out a study into cognitive behaviour therapy (CBT) with internet addicts.

Explain **one** improvement that Young (2007) could have made to her study.

(Total for Question 13 = 2 marks)

Working and answer

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12. Question 21 · part whole · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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21 Joe wanted to investigate conformity. He asked three friends at school to help him conduct his study and act as confederates / stooges.

Joe asked his friends to stand in a group in the corridor during Wednesday lunchtime and all look up and point at the ceiling at a particular time when a single person was passing. He then recorded the reaction of the person passing his friends, in terms of whether they looked up at the ceiling or not.

Explain **two** improvements that could be made to Joe's study into conformity to majority influence.

Improvement 1

Improvement 2

(Total for Question 21 = 4 marks)

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12. Question 21 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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13. Question 24 · part b · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

24 Adam is interested in people's reactions to the influence of authority. He asks male and female participants to come to a room individually.

Half of the male and female participants are asked by a man dressed as a firefighter to lie down on the floor next to the window as there is 'a safety issue in the room'. The other half of the male and female participants are asked by a 'firefighter', who is not in the room, over a loudspeaker, to lie down on the floor next to the window as there is 'a safety issue in the room'.

(a) Explain **two** findings that Adam may discover regarding the participants' reaction to the 'firefighters'.

You should use research evidence about factors affecting obedience to justify your answer.

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13. Question 24 · part b · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **two** improvements that could be made to Adam's study.

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(Total for Question 24 = 8 marks)

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13. Question 24 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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